



Repoussé (hammered relief) decoration

Carefully worked bronze rivets

▲ BRONZE HELMET

Date 250–50BCE

Origin England

Material Bronze

This horned helmet is the only one of its type ever found in Europe, and was probably for ceremonial rather than combat purposes. It is made of bronze sheets riveted together.



▼ SASSANIAN PERSIAN SWORD

Date 6th–7th century CE

Origin Persia

Length 1.05m (3½ft)

Late Sassanian Persian swords were long with narrow blades. They were hung from the belt by two straps, which prevented the scabbard from trailing on the ground and allowed the rapid drawing of the sword.

► HUNNISH BOW

Date 5th century CE

Origin Central Europe

Length 1.25–1.65m (4–5½ft)

The Huns employed compound bows made of horn and wood, which had a greater range than simple bows. The Huns depended on a rapid rate of fire from horseback for their military successes against the Romans in the 5th century CE. The version pictured here is a modern replica.

Bow recurves towards archer

Handle reinforced with bone

A light throwing axe, the *francisca* was commonly used by the Franks — a Germanic group who fought against the Romans from the mid-4th century CE, and who had conquered most of Gaul by the end of the 5th century CE.



Characteristic concave-shaped iron head

► SICKLE SWORD

Date Early 1st century CE

Origin Germany

Length 25.7cm (10in)

This *falx*, or sickle-shaped sword, was found in the Teutoburg Forest in Germany, the site of one of Rome's greatest military defeats, at the hands of Germanic tribes in 9CE. This type of sword was also used by Rome's enemies in Dacia (modern-day Romania) in the 1st and 2nd century CE.

Sickle-shaped blade

Bowstring

Attachment for wooden haft

Jewels form eagle's eye and beak

Cloisonné cross pattern

► EAGLE CLASP

Date c.500CE

Origin Italy

Material Gold, cloisonné

This eagle clasp was probably used to fasten the cloak of a high-status warrior. It comes from the Ostrogoths, a people who occupied Italy from the late 5th century CE.

